# Seven Thousand

*S&P 500 +0.79% to 7,022 — first record close since January 28. Nasdaq +1.59%, 11th straight gain. Morgan Stanley posts record quarter. Ceasefire extension talks advance.*

## THE SESSION

**The S&P 500 closed at 7,022 on Wednesday, recording its first all-time high since January 28 and clearing the 7,000 threshold that had served as the market's reference point for nearly three months. The Nasdaq added 1.59% to 24,016 for its eleventh consecutive advance, led by mega-cap technology and semiconductors. The Dow slipped 0.15% as Caterpillar's 3% decline weighed on the price-weighted average. The Russell 2000 gained 0.30%. The VIX settled at 18.17, down 1.03%, extending the volatility compression that has accompanied the rally off the late-March lows.**

Today's session was driven by a convergence of catalysts. Morgan Stanley reported a record quarter—$20.6 billion in revenue, EPS of $3.43 versus the $3.02 consensus—with equity trading revenue of $5.1 billion and advisory fees up 74% year-over-year. Bank of America beat estimates on the strength of a 21% surge in investment banking fees. The bank earnings cycle has now delivered consistently strong results across JPM, Citi, BAC, and MS, confirming that operating businesses remain robust through the war-era volatility. Separately, the SEC approved the elimination of the $25,000 pattern day-trading minimum, a regulatory shift that sent Robinhood up 10.4% and Coinbase up 6.2%.

On the geopolitical front, the White House confirmed that a second round of US-Iran negotiations is under discussion, with President Trump indicating talks could occur within days in Islamabad. Iran offered a proposal allowing ships to exit the Oman side of Hormuz free of attack, a meaningful concession that helped oil remain subdued—WTI near $91, well below the $115 March highs. The ceasefire expires April 21; the market is pricing extension rather than expiration.

***IOWN Tactical: The index has now recovered from the war-driven drawdown and established a new closing high. With the S&P above the January peak, the Tactical framework remains in observation mode—no trim threshold is active at current levels. The recovery validates the discipline of staying fully invested through the March correction.***

## IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

### WINNERS

**HOOD +10.41%** — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

The SEC eliminated the $25,000 pattern day-trading minimum, directly expanding Robinhood's addressable retail base. Bernstein's prediction market volume projections added fuel—$1 trillion by 2030, with HOOD and COIN as primary beneficiaries. ARK bought 183,000 shares earlier this week.

**COIN +6.23%** — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Rose alongside HOOD on the prediction market thesis. Bernstein named Coinbase an early mover in event contracts. Broader crypto strength supported—Bitcoin near $74,800, IBIT +1.0%.

**ETHA +2.74%** — DIGITAL ASSET ETF

Ethereum ETF tracked the broader digital asset rally as risk appetite improved. IBIT added 1.0% on the day.

**CNX +2.55%** — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Natural gas producer benefited from continued energy repricing. CNX has quietly built a strong run off the March lows as domestic gas demand remains firm.

**SSNC +2.09%** — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Financial technology provider extended its rebound. The bank earnings cycle reinforces demand for back-office infrastructure across asset managers and custodians.

### DECLINERS

**GFI –5.45%** — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Gold Fields declined as gold retreated 0.75% to $4,814 following the risk-on rotation. The precious metals complex gave back gains as equities absorbed the safe-haven bid. AEM also fell 2.52%.

**CAT –3.03%** — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Caterpillar pulled back on valuation concerns ahead of its April 28 earnings report. The stock trades above 30x forward earnings; investors are de-risking into the print. Citi raised its target to $905 but the near-term tape favored profit-taking.

**LRCX –2.66%** — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Lam Research gave back recent gains in a narrow session for semiconductor equipment. The pullback appeared technical rather than fundamental—no adverse news.

**PCAR –1.55%** — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

PACCAR declined in sympathy with the broader industrial rotation out of cyclicals and into growth and financials on the session.

**SYK –1.34%** — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Stryker drifted lower alongside the healthcare sector. UnitedHealth's earnings next week (April 21) continue to weigh on the group's sentiment.

## HOLDINGS NEWS

HOOD: SEC eliminates $25,000 day-trading minimum. FINRA's amended Rule 4210 replaces the fixed threshold with an exposure-based margin standard. The change is directly accretive to Robinhood's retail-heavy user base and could meaningfully increase trading volumes on the platform.

QCOM: $20 billion buyback and dividend increase. Qualcomm authorized a new $20 billion share repurchase program and raised its quarterly dividend, reinforcing capital return discipline. Shares were essentially flat on the day (+0.16%).

NEE: Jefferies raises target on data center deals. NextEra Energy received a price target increase as Jefferies cited the growing pipeline of data center power agreements. Shares were unchanged at $91.24.

CL: Barclays and BofA trim targets. Colgate-Palmolive received cautious notes from both Barclays and Bank of America, with price target reductions reflecting a tempered consumer spending outlook. Shares fell 0.80%.

## PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ✗ TRAIL

**–0.58%**

vs. DVY –0.22% | IWS –0.36%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ✗ TRAIL

**+0.06%**

vs. IUSG +1.23%

**YEAR-TO-DATE**

Dividend +8.76% vs DVY +7.60% / IWS +7.52%
Growth +4.93% vs IUSG +2.18%